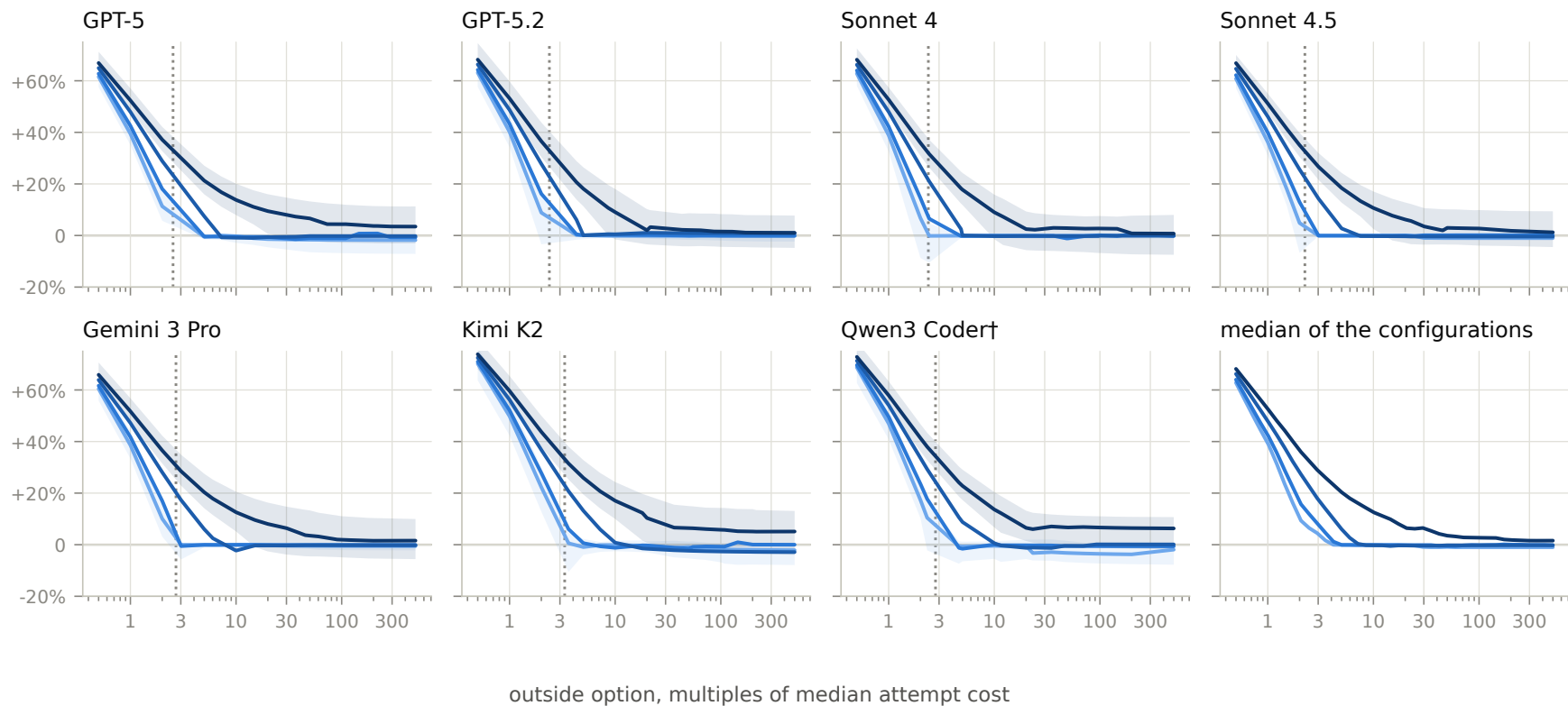


The cap's marginal value given retry (step ii minus step iii)

cap's saving, % of retry's cost



— automated verifier — review at 0.1 H — review at 0.3 H — review at 0.5 H retrying without a cap first beats escalating (automated)*

Positive: the cap saves. Bands: 95% intervals from the full-pipeline bootstrap (1,000 replicates) for the automated verifier and review at 0.5 H, scaled by the point value of step ii. * Exploratory, not registered: to the left of the dotted line, escalating every task without running the agent is cheaper than retrying without a cap. † Qwen3 Coder's dollar figures rest on an imputed price (PLAN.md Section 10).